

Brian Latchman

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Portfolio & Project Writeups: brianlatchman.com — Home lab builds, cybersecurity projects, and more

SUMMARY

Entry-level IT professional with hands-on experience in hardware troubleshooting, system setup, and network configuration. Built and maintained a personal home lab running Docker and virtualized network environments. Holds a Google Cybersecurity Certificate and is actively pursuing CompTIA Security+. Comfortable working in Windows, macOS, and Linux environments. Seeking a PC Support Specialist or Help Desk role to grow within IT and cloud infrastructure.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Operating Systems: Windows 10/11, macOS, Linux (Ubuntu Server)

Networking: TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP, VPN configuration, router/switch setup

Virtualization: Docker, containerized services, virtual networking

Support & Diagnostics: Hardware troubleshooting, software installation, system imaging, remote desktop

Security: Network monitoring, DNS sinkholing, basic penetration testing concepts

Tools & Platforms: Microsoft Office Suite, Google Workspace, ticketing systems, Git, Discord API

Scripting: Python (basic), Bash, Node.js (basic)

EXPERIENCE

Sales Associate

Wallauer Paint, Hardware & Design — Mamaroneck, NY | December 2024 – Present

- Provided front-line customer support and assisted in daily store operations.
- Retrieved and secured surveillance footage for law enforcement, demonstrating attention to detail and technical initiative.
- Assisted with troubleshooting store equipment and basic system operations.
- Collaborated with team members to ensure smooth and efficient store performance.

Handyman Apprentice

Lenmark Co LLC — New York, NY | January 2023 – September 2024

- Managed building security systems, enhancing skills in system monitoring and troubleshooting.
- Coordinated with vendors for technical repairs and installations, developing communication and project management abilities.
- Assisted in maintenance tasks including electrical and HVAC systems, applying diagnostic and problem-solving skills.
- Supported daily operations to maintain a secure and functional environment.

Insurance Agent

Moore-Defurio Agencies — Valhalla, NY | June 2022 – August 2022

- Provided technical support for clients navigating online insurance platforms.
- Attended IT-focused training sessions to improve customer service delivery.

Retail Store Associate

CVS Pharmacy — New Rochelle, NY | January 2020 – October 2021

- Troubleshooting point-of-sale systems and performing software updates to minimize downtime.
- Provided technical assistance for in-store registers and customer-facing equipment.

PROJECTS

Full project documentation and writeups available at brianlatchman.com

Personal Home Server Build & Home Lab

Started by repurposing an old iMac desktop as a first server — wiped it, installed a Linux-based OS, and ran self-hosted services to learn server administration, networking, and system management through hands-on practice. As needs grew, researched and assembled a custom server from scratch, selecting hardware suited for a low-power, always-on workload.

The server runs Ubuntu (full desktop install) and acts as the backbone of the entire home lab, hosting all self-hosted applications, storage, and services. Day-to-day management has built strong experience in Linux system administration, package management, file system management, user permissions, service configuration, and general troubleshooting.

Skills: Hardware building, Ubuntu, Linux administration, terminal usage, server configuration, package management, system troubleshooting, home lab design.

Personal Media & File Server

Configured Ubuntu Server with Jellyfin, and planned integration of Calibre-Web and Audiobookshelf for media and ebook management. Set up remote access via VPN.

Custom Discord Bot (Python / Node.js)

Developed a Discord bot with rotating status messages, image-sending commands, and slash command support using the Discord API. Deployed on a self-hosted Linux server.

Google Cybersecurity Certificate — Labs & Projects

Completed a comprehensive series of hands-on labs and projects covering core cybersecurity domains. Each project involved working through real scenarios using industry-standard tools and frameworks:

- Security Audit & Risk Assessment — Conducted a full internal security audit using NIST-based frameworks. Identified security gaps, risks, and control weaknesses across simulated organizational assets.
- Incident Response Investigation — Analyzed simulated security incidents following the incident response lifecycle from detection through containment and recovery. Documented root causes, attack timelines, and mitigation steps.
- Network Traffic Analysis (Wireshark / tcpdump) — Captured and analyzed live packet data to identify suspicious activity and potential threats. Applied network security monitoring techniques to real traffic.
- SIEM Threat Detection (Splunk / Chronicle) — Worked inside SIEM platforms to investigate security alerts, correlate log data across sources, and identify indicators of compromise (IOCs).
- Linux Security & Log Analysis — Used the Linux command line for system monitoring, log analysis, and security operations tasks. Managed file permissions, reviewed auth/system logs, and applied basic hardening techniques.
- SQL Log Analysis — Wrote SQL queries to extract and analyze security-relevant data from databases. Filtered large log datasets to surface suspicious or unauthorized activity.
- Python Security Automation — Developed Python scripts to automate repetitive security tasks including log parsing, pattern matching, and alert summarization.
- Detection & Response Workflow (IDS/SIEM) — Practiced alert triage, escalation procedures, and response processes. Worked with IDS concepts including Suricata to detect and classify network-based threats.

Skills: NIST frameworks, incident response, Wireshark, tcpdump, Splunk, Chronicle, Linux CLI, SQL, Python, threat modeling, Suricata, SIEM, IDS, log analysis, security auditing.

Personal Website & Portfolio

Designed and deployed a personal portfolio site at brianlatchman.com to document projects, skills, homelab builds, and technical writeups.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Google Cybersecurity Certificate

Issued: February 2024

CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701)

In Progress

Cybersecurity, Systems, & Networking (AAS) — SUNY Genesee Community College

In Progress

Westchester Community College — Business Management

2019–2021 | Relevant coursework: Computer Science Basics, IT Fundamentals

New Rochelle High School

Diploma — June 2019